FOR PARENTS · SUPPORTING YOUR YOUNG PLAYER

OPPORTUNITIES & SCHOLARSHIPS

Spotting a real opportunity, and avoiding the sales pitch

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THE QUICK VERSION

> As your child improves, offers may start to appear: school scholarships, university programs, elite camps, overseas trials or recruitment services. Some are fantastic. Some are expensive sales pitches. A few calm questions help you tell the difference.

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

Genuine opportunities focus on your child's development, education and wellbeing. Less trustworthy ones focus on urgency, big promises and upfront payments. Many great opportunities have clear processes and don't require paying someone to get noticed.

REAL OPPORTUNITY OR SALES PITCH?

SIGNS OF A REAL OPPORTUNITY

- ✓ Clear information in writing
- ✓ Focus on education and development
- ✓ Honest about what's involved
- ✓ Time to think and ask questions

RED FLAGS TO WATCH FOR

- × Guarantees of scholarships or contracts
- × Pressure to sign or pay quickly
- × Large upfront fees with little detail
- × Promises too good to be true

QUESTIONS TO ASK ANY OPPORTUNITY

01 What exactly is included?

02 What does it cost, in total?

03 Who are the coaches or staff?

04 What happened for past players?

05 How does it fit with school?

06 Can we speak to other families?

Success occurs when opportunity meets preparation.

TRY THIS

1. **Take your time**
   A genuine opportunity will still be there after a few days of thinking.
2. **Put education first**
   School and study open doors, with or without football.
3. **Ask for everything in writing**
   Costs, commitments and what happens if plans change.
4. **Talk to trusted people**
   Your child's coach, club or other parents can offer honest advice.
5. **Use the Transfer Window**
   Opportunities shared through Future Baller's Transfer Window come from schools, universities and teams.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
"Let's look into this together."	~~"We have to say yes today."~~
"What do you want from this opportunity?"	~~"This is your only chance."~~
"School comes first, football too."	~~"Forget school, football is your future."~~

QUICK SELF-CHECK

- [ ] I ask questions before saying yes
- [ ] I get costs and details in writing
- [ ] I check references from other families
- [ ] Education stays part of every decision

Can't tick them all yet? That's normal. Pick one to work on this week.

COACH'S CORNER

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The right opportunity will help your child grow as a player and a person. If something is rushing you or promising the world, take a step back and ask more questions.

THE FUTURE BALLER TEAM

Success occurs when opportunity meets preparation.